

THE CLAUDE CODE STACK

One file → a governed agent fleet

CLAUDE.md + Skills + Hooks + Subagents + MCP + Plugins = an engineering system, not a chatbot

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CLAUDE.md

The Memory Layer

- Global → project → auto memory hierarchy
- One source of truth for rules & conventions

- Routing over organizing — point, don't pile

Day 1

2

SKILLS

The Knowledge Layer

- SKILL.md + a pushy description that triggers
- Scripts & references, one level deep

- Progressive disclosure — loads only when needed

Day 2

3

HOOKS

The Guardrail Layer

- 27 lifecycle events · 4 handler types
- Lint on write · block risky commands · alert on stop

- Deterministic, not AI — policy as code

Day 2

4

SUBAGENTS & TEAMS

The Delegation Layer

- Isolated context per agent — main stays clean
- Agent teams for parallel workstreams

- Nested delegation up to 5 levels (Jun 2026)

Day 3

5

MCP

The Connection Layer

- External tools: APIs, databases, GitHub
- Every server costs context — audit the tax

- studio local · HTTP remote · claude mcp login

Day 3

6

PLUGINS

The Distribution Layer

- Skills + hooks + commands + MCP in one bundle
- Install once — your whole team gets the stack

- claude plugin init → team marketplace

Day 2

